

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 186

By Oliver

A RESOLUTION to honor Shugga Hi Bakery and Café for serving delicious and nourishing food to the Nashville community.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize an outstanding restaurant that has earned loyal customers and received critical accolades for its far-ranging menu and delectable dishes; and

WHEREAS, Shugga Hi Bakery and Café was founded in 2017 by sisters Sandra Austin, a banker, and Kathy Leslie, an attorney, neither of whom had any restaurant experience; and

WHEREAS, native Nashvillians, the late Sandra Austin (Shugga San) and Kathy Leslie (Shugga Kat) were inspired to start their own restaurant by their mother, Catherine, and the fine example she set; and

WHEREAS, every night, Catherine prepared dinner, including dessert, for her family after completing her full-time shift as a nurse; as a special treat, she sometimes allowed her children to sample the dessert before the meal; and

WHEREAS, when the family gathered together around the dinner table to eat, talk, and enjoy each other's company, Sandra and Kathy experienced a feeling of love that they wanted to share with their community, and thus, Shugga Hi was born many years later; and

WHEREAS, from its humble origins as a small bakery that was the province of master baker, Sandra Austin, Shugga Hi has grown leaps and bounds to become a major player in the revitalization of the Dickerson Pike corridor; and

WHEREAS, its Jazz and Eggs Sunday brunch buffet truly put Shugga Hi on the map, transforming the café into a lively, post-church destination; and

WHEREAS, Shugga Hi proudly served as a sponsor and caterer for the NFL draft held in Nashville in April 2019; and

WHEREAS, Shugga Hi survived the COVID pandemic and was beginning to strengthen its brand when tragedy struck in September 2021 with the passing of Sandra Austin; her sister, Kathy Leslie, was heartbroken but determined to carry on their joint legacy at Shugga Hi; and

WHEREAS, a mere two months later, Shugga Hi hosted its fifth annual Community Harvest Meal to honor the life of co-founder Sandra Austin; and

WHEREAS, on November 18, 2021, Ms. Leslie joined with her staff, local elected officials, and volunteers to distribute 800 free meals to members of the community who were in need; and

WHEREAS, today, Shugga Hi Bakery and Café features an extensive menu, but the restaurant's crowning glory and fan favorite is its chicken and waffles dish, which includes "mouthwatering, juicy, crisp chicken on top of a fluffy, moist, melanated golden cake waffle with a side of Henny syrup"; and

WHEREAS, Shugga Hi's selection is truly outstanding, as is the management's commitment to friendly customer service; every customer becomes a member of the Shugga Hi family and is welcome to sit at Momma's table; and

WHEREAS, an icon in Nashville since 2017, Shugga Hi is deserving of our recognition as a bastion of good food and even better company; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Shugga Hi Bakery and Café for serving delicious and nourishing food to the Nashville community, thank Kathy Leslie and her employees for extending a warm welcome to people from all walks of life, and wish them all the best in their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.